Lead Broker Blueprint by Lorenzo Marietti

Module 6 — Operations and Tooling

The Tech Stack Deployment Playbook

Day-one through year-one — what to buy, when to add it, why operators regret skipping it, and the integration sequence that actually works.

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How to use this playbook

Module 6 explains what each piece of the lead-broker tech stack does. This playbook tells you which pieces to buy on day one, which to add at day 30, day 90, and day 365 — and the exact integration order that prevents the rebuild-everything trap operators fall into when they grow.

The stack is described in three tiers. Most new operators should start at Tier 1 (~$200/mo) and progress only when revenue justifies the next tier. Skipping ahead is a common mistake: paying $5,000/mo for tooling before you have $5,000/mo of revenue is how new operations die.

Three operating principles

1. Start cheap. Upgrade when the pain shows up.

Every operator who has scaled past $50k/mo of revenue started with a stack that would embarrass them now. That's correct. Cheap tools force you to feel the friction of every problem before you spend money to fix it. Friction is information.

2. Integration debt compounds. Pick tools that talk to each other.

Standalone best-of-breed tools that don't integrate cost more in operational overhead than slightly-worse integrated stacks. Buy the platform that does 80% of what you need, not the five point-solutions that each do 95% of one piece.

3. The compliance stack is non-negotiable from day one.

Marketing tooling can be cheap and improvised. Compliance tooling (TrustedForm/Jornaya, DNC scrubbing, call recording, consent capture) cannot. Buyers refuse to pay for leads without proper consent documentation, and regulators have no patience for "we hadn't gotten around to it." Compliance is the foundation; everything else sits on top.

Tier 1 — The day-one stack (~$200-$500/month)

Goal of Tier 1: ship your first lead to your first buyer, with full compliance, at the lowest possible cost. The stack below covers form intake, consent capture, DNC scrubbing, call tracking, basic CRM, and email.

This is what you can be operational on within 7-10 days of activating the rest of the Blueprint.

Landing page and form builder

Recommended: Unbounce, Instapage, or Leadpages — ~$80-$150/mo

Any of the three works. Pick by which has the cleanest builder for your skill level. Set up: build one landing page per vertical/geo combo, embed the form with 4-7 fields, fire submission to your CRM via webhook or Zapier.

Alternatives if you have any technical capacity: Webflow (~$30/mo) for full design control. Hostinger Website Builder if you need a cheap starter. Self-hosted React or Astro if you can ship code yourself — costs $5/mo of hosting, but takes longer to iterate.

Consent capture (TrustedForm or Jornaya — required, not optional)

Recommended: TrustedForm by ActiveProspect — $0.05-$0.25 per certificate

TrustedForm injects a JavaScript snippet on your landing page that records the consumer's interaction with the consent disclosure and produces a certificate URL that proves consent. Buyers in regulated verticals (PI, mortgage, Medicare, insurance) require this with every lead.

Jornaya is the major alternative; works essentially the same way. Some buyers specify one or the other. If you don't know your buyer's preference yet, start with TrustedForm — it has slightly broader market coverage.

Critical: install the snippet on EVERY page that captures consent. Test that the certificate URL is generating on each submission. Add the URL to every lead record in your CRM. Buyers refuse leads without it — and your dispute defense is dramatically weaker without it.

DNC scrubbing

Recommended: Contact Center Compliance (DNC.com) or PossibleNOW — $50-$200/mo

Every outbound call to a consumer phone number must be scrubbed against the federal DNC registry plus state DNC registries plus internal suppression lists at the moment of dial. The scrub result must be logged.

These platforms provide API endpoints your dialer or call platform calls in real time before placing each call. Scrub fails → don't dial. Scrub passes → dial and log the timestamp + scrub result with the call record.

Skipping DNC scrubbing produces TCPA class actions. Plaintiff firms actively monitor for violations. Don't even start without this in place.

Call tracking and routing

Recommended: Ringba (pay-per-call focus) or CallRail (form-and-call hybrid) — $145-$500/mo to start

Ringba is the dominant pay-per-call platform — purpose-built for routing inbound calls to multiple buyers with bidding, ping/post mechanics, whisper messages, and recording. The standard for serious operators in HVAC, legal, Medicare, and home services.

CallRail is more generalist — call tracking + attribution + basic routing. Better fit if you're also serving form leads heavily. Less optimized for high-volume pay-per-call routing but easier to set up.

For Tier 1, pick one. Standard tradeoff: Ringba if pay-per-call is >50% of your volume; CallRail if forms dominate.

CRM / lead management

Recommended: HubSpot Free or Pipedrive — $0-$50/mo to start

At Tier 1 you don't need a real LMS (lead management system). You need a CRM that captures every form submission, every call, every disposition, and lets you tag and filter. HubSpot Free, Pipedrive, or Notion-as-CRM all work.

What you absolutely need to track per lead: source, qualification status, timestamp at each step, recording URL, TrustedForm certificate URL, buyer name, disposition (transferred / scheduled / disqualified / returned), and payout.

Email and SMS

Recommended: Resend (transactional email) + SimpleTexting or EZ Texting (SMS) — $20-$100/mo

Transactional email (lead confirmations, calendar invites for callbacks, internal alerts) goes through Resend, Postmark, or similar. SMS for opt-in funnels and reminders goes through a TCPA-compliant SMS platform.

Don't use Gmail or Outlook for transactional email. Deliverability collapses, you can't get DKIM/SPF right at scale, and you'll start landing in spam folders within a week.

Tier 1 total cost

Realistic monthly cost for a Tier 1 stack actually running: $200-$500/mo, depending on which call-tracking and CRM choices you make. Some operators run with $150/mo for the first few weeks; most settle at $300-$400/mo by month two.

Tier 2 — The growth stack ($1,000-$5,000/month)

Goal of Tier 2: handle multi-buyer routing across 3-10 buyer relationships, with proper LMS, automated qualification, dispute tracking, and reporting. You're ready for Tier 2 when you have 3+ active buyer relationships and your CRM-based routing is breaking.

Add: real LMS (Lead Management System)

Recommended: LeadConduit (by ActiveProspect) — $500-$2,500/mo

LeadConduit is the dominant LMS for lead-gen operations in the $50k-$500k/mo range. It does lead intake, automated qualification rules, multi-buyer routing (ping/post, auction, tier-based, round-robin), buyer-specific spec sheets, return management, and reporting. Tight integration with TrustedForm (same parent company).

Alternatives: Boberdoo ($500-$2,000/mo, dominant in legal/PI), Leadspedia ($800-$3,000/mo, multi-vertical), Phonexa ($1,000-$5,000/mo, especially strong on pay-per-call routing and AI-driven optimization). Pick by vertical fit and buyer-stack preference.

Upgrade: call platform

Recommended: Ringba Pro or Phonexa Voice — $500-$2,000/mo

Add the advanced features: dynamic number insertion across all paid channels, whisper messages with full qualification data, conditional routing rules, real-time bid management for ping/post, multi-tier waterfall logic. These produce 15-30% revenue lift over basic call tracking once volume is high enough to amortize.

Add: AI voice or conversational layer

Recommended: Vapi, Bland.ai, Retell, or Synthflow — $300-$1,500/mo

AI voice agents for inbound first-touch (greeting + basic qualification before human handoff). Frees your human agents for the higher-leverage warm transfer and closing work. See the Modern & Emerging Channels deliverable Section 1.3-1.4 for full deployment guidance.

Add: business intelligence and reporting

Recommended: Google Sheets + Looker Studio (free) or Domo / Looker proper ($1,000+/mo at scale)

By Tier 2 you need a daily dashboard showing volume by source, by vertical, by buyer; CAC by channel; net contribution; dispute rates; buyer-side acceptance rates. Most operators start with Sheets + Looker Studio (free) and graduate to Domo/Looker around $200k/mo revenue.

Add: financial and AP/AR

Recommended: QuickBooks Online + Bill.com or Ramp — $50-$300/mo

You're invoicing 5-10 buyers monthly, paying ad platforms, paying contractors, tracking taxes. QuickBooks Online handles the accounting; Bill.com or Ramp handles vendor payments. Both integrate cleanly with most LMSs for revenue tracking.

Tier 2 total cost

Realistic monthly Tier 2 cost: $1,500-$4,500/mo all-in. Adds ~$1,500-$4,000/mo over Tier 1. Justifies itself at roughly $20,000+/mo in revenue.

Tier 3 — The scale stack ($5,000-$20,000+/month)

Goal of Tier 3: operate at $200k-$1M+/mo revenue across multiple verticals and geographies, with real ops staff, proper compliance program, multi-buyer auction routing, and the data infrastructure to detect quality drift before buyers do.

Add: enterprise LMS or custom

Recommended: LeadConduit Enterprise, Boberdoo Pro, or custom builds — $2,500-$15,000/mo

At scale, most operations either go enterprise on their existing LMS (negotiated pricing, dedicated support, custom workflows) or build a custom layer on top. Custom builds become defensible at $500k+/mo revenue.

Add: data warehouse and analytics

Recommended: BigQuery or Snowflake + dbt — $500-$5,000/mo

Ingest every system's data daily. Run cohort analyses, channel attribution properly, predict CAC trends, identify quality drift early. Operators running tight data ops detect buyer-side quality complaints before the buyer escalates.

Add: compliance program tooling

Recommended: Drata, Vanta, or compliance consultancy — $1,000-$10,000/mo

By Tier 3 you have meaningful TCPA/FTC exposure. Formal compliance programs reduce risk and signal sophistication to enterprise buyers. Includes annual audits, training programs, documented procedures, and incident response.

Add: dedicated compliance counsel

Retain outside counsel familiar with TCPA, FTC, state telemarketing/privacy laws, and your vertical-specific regulations. Quarterly check-ins. Annual program audit. Counsel becomes worth their retainer the first time you get a demand letter or class-action notice.

Tier 3 total cost

Realistic monthly Tier 3 cost: $5,000-$25,000/mo. Plus 4-8 ops staff. Justifies itself at $250k+/mo revenue. Beyond $1M/mo the structure can support custom builds and proprietary tooling that don't appear on any vendor's pricing page.

The integration sequence (the 60-day onboarding)

Operators who skip steps in this sequence regret it. The order is non-negotiable; the timing is flexible by ±1 week.

Week 1 — Compliance foundation

1. Register your business entity (LLC). Without it, every TCPA claim hits you personally.
2. Set up TrustedForm account. Get the snippet installed on a test landing page.
3. Sign up for DNC.com or equivalent. Test the API with a known DNC-listed number.
4. Set up call recording compliant with your state's wiretap law (one-party or two-party).
5. Draft and post your privacy policy, terms of service, and consent disclosures. Use a template — Module 3 deliverables have these — but get counsel review.

Week 2 — Landing page and form

6. Pick your landing page builder (Unbounce/Instapage/Leadpages or Webflow). Build one page for one vertical in one geo.
7. Embed TrustedForm. Verify certificates generate on every submission.
8. Wire submission to your CRM via webhook or Zapier.
9. Test the consumer journey end-to-end with your own information.

Week 3 — Call routing and CRM

10. Set up Ringba or CallRail. Provision tracked numbers for your initial campaigns.
11. Configure CRM tagging for source, qualification status, disposition, buyer.
12. Set up the daily-summary dashboard (Sheets + Looker Studio for free).

Week 4 — First buyer onboarding

13. Sign your first pilot agreement (per Module 4 playbook).
14. Configure routing in your stack — even if just for one buyer initially.
15. Test lead delivery end-to-end with a sample lead.
16. Confirm the buyer's CRM accepts the lead format correctly.

Week 5-6 — First production leads

17. Launch paid campaigns. Start small (~$200/day) so problems surface at low cost.
18. Run intake on every lead within 5 minutes of submission.
19. Track quality metrics daily. Adjust qualification rules based on observed lead profile.

Week 7-8 — Add buyer 2 and refine

20. Sign the second buyer relationship. Configure routing waterfall (Tier 1 → Tier 2).
21. Add basic dispute-handling workflow per Module 4 Lead-Quality Dispute Decision Tree.
22. Begin daily summary emails to buyers showing leads delivered, qualified, returned.

Week 9-10 — Operational hygiene

23. Document every operational SOP in writing — intake script, dispute response, return process, payout reconciliation. Templates in Module 6 Sample SOPs deliverable.
24. Set up weekly buyer-relationship reviews (volume, quality, payment status).

Switching costs and platform lock-in

Picking the wrong platform isn't fatal — but switching costs are non-trivial. Plan for them.

What's expensive to switch later

- LMS choice (LeadConduit vs Boberdoo vs Phonexa). Buyer integrations, qualification rules, reporting all live in your LMS. Switching costs: 2-4 weeks of operational disruption + ~$10,000-$30,000 in re-integration work at scale.
- Call platform (Ringba vs CallRail vs Phonexa Voice). Tracked numbers, routing logic, recordings live here. Switching costs: 4-8 weeks for full number-porting + routing rebuild.
- CRM. Lead history, buyer records, dispositions. Switching mid-operation requires careful data migration. Easier if you do it before lead volume scales.

What's cheap to switch later

- Landing page builder. A new builder takes 2-3 days to rebuild your 5-10 active pages. Low lock-in.
- Email transactional provider (Resend, Postmark, SendGrid). Drop-in replacement; takes a day to swap.
- SMS provider. Numbers can be ported; phone tree logic moves easily.
- Reporting/BI. Just dashboards on top of underlying data.

How to choose, given switching costs

Spend the LEAST time deliberating on cheap-to-switch tools. Pick the obvious choice and move on. Spend the MOST time deliberating on expensive-to-switch tools — LMS, call platform, CRM. Ask buyers in your network which they use. Read recent operator commentary in LeadsCouncil community. Trial each major option for 2-4 weeks before committing.

Common stack mistakes and how to avoid them

Mistake 1 — Buying tools before you have leads

New operators get excited and buy a $500/mo LMS in week one, before they have any leads to manage. The tool sits unused; the monthly fee burns runway. Rule: tools come after demand, not before. Wait until your existing tool actively prevents you from operating.

Mistake 2 — Buying point solutions that don't integrate

Best-of-breed everything sounds appealing. Five tools that each export to CSVs that you reconcile manually is operational hell. Buy the platform that does 80% of what you need.

Mistake 3 — Skipping compliance tooling to save money

Skipping TrustedForm/Jornaya saves $50-$200/mo and costs you all your serious buyers. Skipping DNC scrubbing saves $50-$100/mo and costs you a six-figure class action. Compliance tooling is the foundation; cheap out anywhere except here.

Mistake 4 — Custom-building before you've operated

Engineers who become operators are tempted to build their own LMS or call platform. Don't. Use the off-the-shelf platform until you've operated for 12+ months, then evaluate whether the custom build is worth $100k+ of engineering time. 90% of the time, the platform is fine.

Mistake 5 — Letting tooling complexity outrun operational discipline

A $5,000/mo stack run by a team that hasn't documented its SOPs produces worse results than a $500/mo stack run with discipline. Tools amplify what you already do; they don't substitute for doing it well.

> *Pick your day-one stack. Sign up for the tools. Run your first lead through it before you read another book about lead generation. The work is in the doing, not in the planning.*

— Lorenzo
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